TECHNICAL SUPPORT

Deployment & troubleshooting guide

How to deploy your agent on Alternate Clouds, and how to fix the errors teams hit most often. Find your error in the table below and jump to its fix.

Quick finder

If you see…	Go to
Cloudflare “502 Bad Gateway” on your public URL	**01 · Port mismatch**
You pushed to GitHub but the live app didn’t change	**02 · Rebuild, then deploy**
Build succeeds, then the app crashes on startup (KeyError)	**03 · Missing API key**
`Error: no active leases found` from the CLI	**04 · Outdated CLI**
n8n credentials or webhooks not working	**05 · n8n configuration**
Anything else	**06 · Read your logs, then 07 · Ask for help**

Official links

Alternate Clouds dashboard	clouds.alternatefutures.ai
Alternate Futures documentation	docs.alternatefutures.ai
Alternate Clouds CLI (npm)	www.npmjs.com/package/@alternatefutures/acc
Groq console (free, fast AI keys)	console.groq.com/keys
n8n documentation	docs.n8n.io

The golden rule: set your variables first, then Rebuild, then Deploy. Building the image and putting it live are two separate steps.

01 The port mismatch trap (502 Bad Gateway)

SYMPTOM	You open your public URL and see a Cloudflare “502 Bad Gateway” error.
CAUSE	Alternate Clouds sends traffic to one port (for example 8000), but your app (FastAPI, Express, Node.js) is listening on another (for example 3000).
FIX	1. Check your `Dockerfile` or main app file for the port it `EXPOSE`s or runs on. 2. In the Alternate Clouds dashboard, open the **Source** tab and make sure **PORT** matches your code exactly. 3. **Rebuild**, then **Deploy**.

02 I pushed new code to GitHub, but my app didn’t update

SYMPTOM	Your GitHub repo has the new code, but the live URL still shows the old version or an old error.
CAUSE	Building the image and pushing it live are two separate steps. A push alone does neither.
FIX	1. Open your service in the Alternate Clouds dashboard. 2. On the **Source** tab, click **Rebuild** (bottom right). 3. Wait for the build to succeed. 4. Click **Deploy** to put the new container live.

03 The missing API key crash

SYMPTOM	The build succeeds, but the app crashes on startup, or the Logs tab shows a `KeyError` (Python).
CAUSE	Your code needs an API key (OpenAI, Groq and so on) to start, but the key was never added to the container’s environment.
FIX	1. Add every variable from your **.env** before deploying: on the **Variables** tab in the web UI, or with the `--env` flag in the CLI. 2. **Rebuild**, then **Deploy**. 3. Never commit your .env file or paste keys into your code.

04 The “no active leases” CLI error

SYMPTOM	You run `acc services create` and it fails straight away with `Error: no active leases found`.
CAUSE	The Alternate Clouds backend was updated, and your local CLI is out of date, so it sends an invalid deployment manifest.

FIX	1. Update the CLI:
	`npm i -g @alternatefutures/acc`
	2. Close the failed deployment to free your resources:
	`acc services close <your-service-id>`
	3. Run your original deployment command again.

05 n8n configuration rules (required for AI agents)

SYMPTOM	Credentials won’t save or load, or your webhooks never fire.
CAUSE	An n8n template needs two environment variables. If either is missing or mistyped, the workflow breaks.

FIX	• `N8N_ENCRYPTION_KEY`: a 32-character string that protects the credentials n8n saves, like your API keys. Generate one with either command, or type any 32 random letters and numbers.
	`# Windows (PowerShell)`
	`[System.Guid]::NewGuid().ToString("N")`
	`# Mac / Linux`
	`openssl rand -hex 16`
	• `WEBHOOK_URL`: Alternate Clouds routes traffic by your exact service name. If your service is called `my-ai-agent` (`--name my-ai-agent`), set:
	`WEBHOOK_URL=https://my-ai-agent-app.alternatefutures.ai`
	• Keep the same encryption key for the life of the service. Changing it later means n8n can no longer read the credentials it already saved.

06 Read your logs first

The **Logs** tab in the Alternate Clouds dashboard is the single source of truth. Check it before anything else.

- **Healthy:** look for messages like `Application startup complete`.
- **Broken:** look for Python or Node.js errors, the line they point to, and the last thing that happened before the crash.

07 Asking for help on Discord

Stuck? Post in **#support** on the Alternate Futures Discord. The Grayhat and Alternate Futures technical team will help. Write **in English** and include all three:

1. **Your code:** a link to your GitHub repo, or a screenshot of your Dockerfile and main file.
2. **Your error:** the log output **pasted as text in a code block**, so the team can search and copy it. Add a screenshot of the Logs tab if it helps.
3. **Your steps:** exactly what you did before the error appeared.

Remove API keys, tokens and passwords from logs and screenshots before you post.